

variables before you run the configure script.

Consider these commands:

```
export CFLAGS="-O3 -march=core2"
```

```
export CXXFLAGS="-O3 -march=core2"
```

Here we're setting up the aforementioned environment variables with optimisations suitable for the Intel Core 2 CPU architecture. But if you are a AMD fanboy and have a AMD64 chip you can use

```
export CFLAGS="-O3 -march=athlon64"
```

```
export CXXFLAGS="-O3 -march=athlon64"
```

Some other march codes are pentium3, pentium4, athlon-xp.

Now the **-O3** parameter at the start tells the compiler to do the third level of optimisation. By default, generally for favour of slightly smaller size and easier debugging, most binary builds are set at **-O2**.

The list of possible optimisation tweaks are endless, open the makefile, try and go through each option and see what you can tweak, as always remember that "Google" is your best friend.

3.5 Reporting bugs and getting help

We have only looked till now for the utopian case where everything works as expected, but there are situations when things don't end so smoothly. In such cases, user and developer forums along with IRC channels are the best way to directly ask your question and in most cases receive answers.

If, after all searching, you are still stuck, feel free to ask your doubt. There is an expected and accepted format to do so. For example a post like the following is exactly how you shouldn't do it.

"Hey dude, my software isn't compiling, can you help???"

Here is a list of things wrong with the above:

Multiple question marks. We're not kidding, most experienced users who are you best bet have an extreme irritation to multiple question marks or exclamation marks.

It provides no details. You should provide a level of detail, via which the problem can be replicated. It is strongly advised to include the following details:

Exact name and version of your operating system, processor